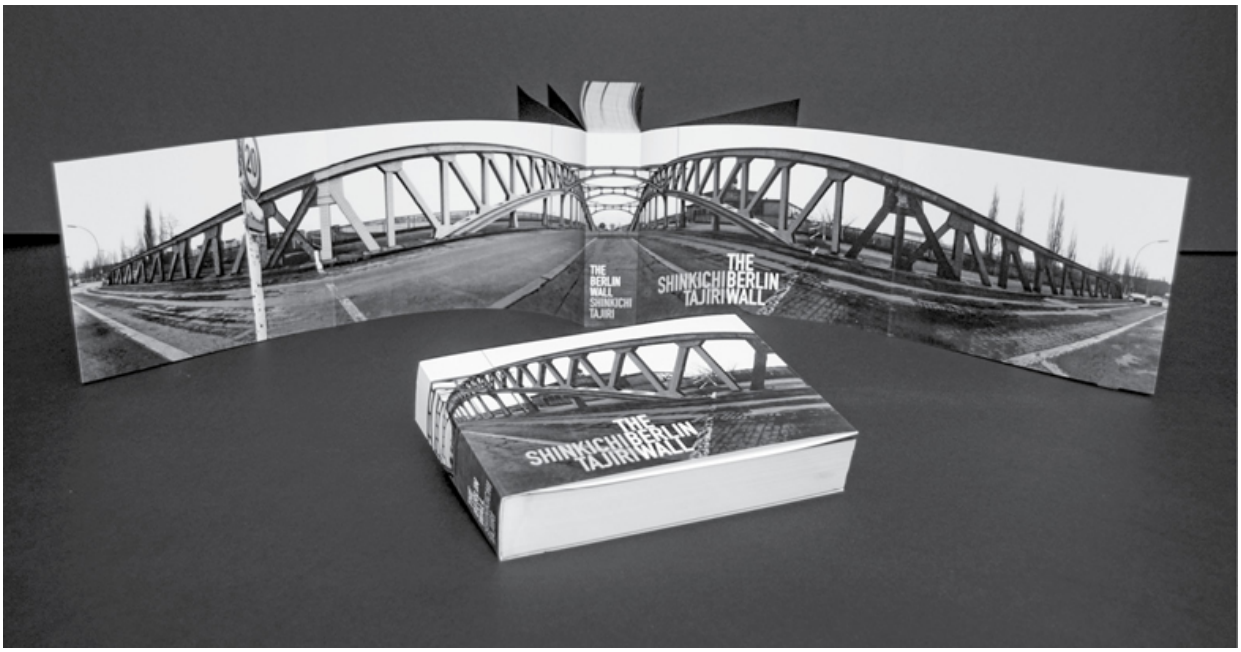


FIGURE 5.6 Shinkichi Tajiri, *The Berlin Wall*, 2005. (Shinkichi Tajiri Estate/Tasha B.V.)

Even as his project seemed to cohere in its own finished point of publication, his essay hinted at future iterations. In the published version, he gestured at the unfinished nature of the project: “I have tried to reconstruct the proper order but I am not 100% certain if I have succeeded. I would appreciate any corrections remedied in a later edition.”[27]

After the book was completed, Tajiri experienced several unfortunate disruptions. He sued the printer because his negatives had been cropped and unapproved changes had been made to the individual images. Soon after, he became ill, and he made notes for his daughters Giotto and Ryu Tajiri to carry out the project to his intended specifications in any future exhibitions and versions. To this day, his former studio holds a small-scale model he envisioned for a panoramic pavilion of his 1981 project. Made with images from his archive, the model is located close to the chunks of the Berlin Wall by his windows. Tajiri passed away in his studio in Baarlo in March 2009 at age eighty-six.

Despite living outside the United States for over six decades, Tajiri retained his U.S. citizenship throughout his life. But at age eighty-five, a year before his death, Tajiri finally became a dual citizen with the Netherlands, his adopted home. Continuing to grapple with his American identity in self-exile, he remained a vocal critic of U.S. militarism, retaining